

Travel Hackathon PRD

2026-09-18 · Miles Wolfe (Specno) · Living copy:
<https://claude.ai/code/artifact/905d20e9-5c9f-48cd-b522-fbbea6ccdfb5>

One-Line Statement

A marketplace that removes the technological and financial barriers keeping local South Africans out of the tourism economy, so anyone with something authentic to offer can list it by voice, get booked by travellers co-planning their journey, and get paid — without a bank account, a website, or reliable data.

Working name: TBD (see Decisions Needed). Everything below is a starting position for the 24-hour build; items marked *to validate* need a real-world check before they are stated as fact in the pitch.

Why this wins. Most travel hackathon entries will be traveller-facing apps that make booking prettier. Ours flips the camera: the hero is the host, not the tourist. The demo moment is a person speaking a voice note in isiXhosa on an entry-level Android and watching it become a live, bookable listing — then watching a payout land on their phone number, no bank account required. That is Idea, Design, Impact and Pitch in one 60-second sequence, and it lands squarely on the brief's themes of financial inclusion, experiential travel, sharing experience, and building for the journey, not the destination.

The Problem

Tourism is one of South Africa's largest job-creating sectors, but its benefits concentrate in hotels, franchises and established operators. The people with the most authentic offering — the local guide, the taxi driver, the home cook, the crafter, the person who knows who to call — are structurally excluded from the platforms where travellers spend money. Money flows past the people who make a place worth visiting.

The exclusion has three causes, and the product must answer all three:

Exclusion	What incumbents assume	Reality for the host
Technological	Good smartphone, cheap reliable data, written English, photo editing, long web forms	Entry-level Android, a rationed prepaid bundle, patchy coverage, more comfort speaking than typing

Exclusion	What incumbents assume	Reality for the host
Financial	Identity verified with a card; payouts to a bank account	Unbanked or underbanked, lives on cash, receives money via eWallet-style products
Trust	A brand, reviews and verification the host already has	No way to be found or trusted by a stranger, so demand never reaches them and the informal economy stays informal

The demand-side gap. Travellers want authentic local experiences and will pay for them, but have no safe, trusted way to find, book and pay a local individual. They get a sanitised, operator-led version of the country instead. Groups of friends and family, in particular, have no good way to plan a journey together and agree on it before committing money.

To validate for the pitch: current SA unbanked/underbanked share, tourism's contribution to GDP and jobs, and the share of tourism spend reaching township and rural economies. Use a sourced figure or say "approximately" — never an invented statistic on stage.

Theme Alignment: The Journey, Not the Destination

The brief asks teams to build for the journey. Our product is about who a traveller spends the journey with, and about the journey a host takes from "I have something to offer" to "I have been paid". Both journeys are visible on screen in the demo.

Brief theme	How we hit it
Experiential travel	Listings are people and their stories, not products; travellers choose a host
Eco / local travel	Spend stays in the community; low-data, low-footprint tooling
Learning as you travel	Cultural exchange, host storytelling, multilingual listings
Independent travel	Self-steered, drag-and-drop, group-voted itinerary

Brief theme	How we hit it
Sharing experience	Shareable itinerary links, two-way reviews, host stories
Financial inclusion	Voice-first onboarding, bank-account-optional payouts, tiered KYC
On-the-ground support	A named, verified local behind every experience; WhatsApp contact
Security	Tiered verification, share-trip, emergency button, regulated-category checks
Transport	A first-class listing category (taxi, bakkie, transfers)
Language barriers	Voice in the host's language, auto-translation both ways
Moments of memory	Photo/video-rich listings; post-trip reviews with photos

USP and Inclusion Principles

The unique value is on the supply side. Every marketplace can show listings to travellers. Ours is built so that a person with an entry-level phone, no bank account and limited written English can go from "I have something to offer" to "I have been paid" without help. The demand side must be good, but it is not what makes the product different.

Four pillars of the USP:

1. **Onboarding that meets people where they are.** Voice-first listing creation in the host's own language, one question at a time, on a low-data, offline-capable PWA, with WhatsApp and SMS as first-class channels. Community Champions (elected locally, surveyed via WhatsApp/Yazi or Facebook forums) act as the human on-ramp for hosts who need a hand.
2. **Verification that builds trust without re-excluding.** Tiered KYC: start with a phone number and an ID, earn trust through credentials *or* community endorsement rather than paperwork the host may not have.
3. **Payouts that work without a bank account.** Cash-send to a phone number, mobile wallets, retail cash pickup. Being unbanked is not a barrier to earning.

4. **Dignity and control.** Hosts see exactly what they earn in rand before publishing, own their listings, set their own prices and availability, and are treated as entrepreneurs, not gig labour.

Mission: reduce technological and financial exclusion in travel so lower-LSM South Africans can contribute to and benefit from tourism.

Design principles — every feature in this PRD is held to these:

Principle	What it means in practice
Low data	Supply-side first load under 500 KB; aggressive image compression on upload; no video autoplay; text-first screens
Offline first	Hosts can create/edit offerings and see bookings without signal; sync later; never lose work
Low literacy, low friction	Voice-first; one question per screen; big touch targets; icons with labels; EN/AF/XH/ZU at MVP, all 11 languages as the goal
Bank account optional	A host must be able to get paid without one
Entry-level device	Runs well on a ~R1,500 Android; PWA not app-store; WhatsApp/USSD for the lowest-tech hosts
Trust by design	Verification and safety protect both sides without becoming a barrier that re-excludes
Supply side first	When host simplicity and traveller convenience conflict, the host wins

Users

Hosts (supply) are the primary user.

Host persona	What they offer	What they need
The local guide	Walks, stories, the area, the people; may or may not be a registered guide	Flexible income; to show their place properly
The transport operator	Minibus taxi, bakkie, small-town e-hailing: airport runs, transfers, lifts to the trailhead	Bookings that fit around existing routes
The home cook or maker	Traditional meals, a shebeen, baking, brewing, crafts; small groups at home or a community venue	Simple availability; a fair price
The concierge	Knows who to call: arranges the braai, the boat, the choir, the farm visit	To sell access and coordination
The security escort	Foot or vehicle escort, night escort, event presence (regulated: PSIRA)	Credential-gated listing
The Community Champion	Elected by their community; onboards and vouches for neighbouring hosts	A simple champion view and endorsement power

Shared traits to design for: entry-level Android, prepaid data, may be unbanked, prefers speaking to typing, low written English, high trust in WhatsApp and voice notes, paid in cash today, may share one phone within a household, may have a day job and limited availability.

Travellers (demand).

Traveller persona	Wants	Needs
International visitor	"Real" South Africa beyond the Waterfront and the lodge	Safety, English, clear expectations, card payment
Domestic traveller	Something local on a holiday, family visit or road trip	Easy discovery by place and route

Traveller persona	Wants	Needs
Business traveller	A free evening or half day filled at short notice	Instant book, close by
Group organiser	A family trip, bachelor weekend or team offsite everyone agrees on	Co-created itinerary, group voting, one payment

The group organiser is the demand-side persona the demo should centre: the co-created, voted itinerary is our most distinctive traveller feature.

Solution Overview

A two-sided PWA marketplace. Hosts list by voice and get paid to a phone number; travellers co-create a journey from those listings and pay once. The platform holds the money and releases it to the host after the experience happens.

None

flowchart LR

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    A[Community surveyed<br/>WhatsApp / Facebook] --> B[Champion elected<br/>and inducted]
    B --> C[Host records voice note<br/>in own language]
    C --> D[AI drafts listing<br/>host reviews and publishes]
    D --> E[Travellers browse<br/>and co-build itinerary]
    E --> F[Group votes<br/>and pays once]
    F --> G[Host accepts<br/>via app or WhatsApp]
    G --> H[Experience happens]
    H --> I[Payout to phone number<br/>no bank account needed]

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Reading left to right: supply is built by communities and champions, converted into listings by voice, consumed by groups planning together, and closed by a payout the host can actually collect.

Supply side. Communities are reached through WhatsApp (Yazi) surveys or Facebook community forums and elect Community Champions. Champions are inducted through a conversational interview in a WhatsApp-like UI, then help onboard hosts around them. Any host can record a voice note describing what they offer; AI transcribes, translates and drafts the structured listing, which the host corrects and publishes. Verification is tiered so a phone number and ID are enough to start.

Demand side. Travellers browse listings by place, category or route, as a visual timeline. A group drags experience blocks onto a shared itinerary, votes, and confirms. One checkout pays

for everything; each host accepts their booking with one tap. After completion the host is paid to a bank account, a cash-send number, a wallet or a retail pickup.

What is new here versus incumbents: voice-to-listing in SA languages, community endorsement as a trust tier, unbanked payouts as a first-class flow, and group co-creation with voting as the planning model.

Supply-Side Flows

Register

- Phone number is the identity. OTP over SMS or WhatsApp. No email.
- Choose language first, before anything else. Then choose how to be contacted (in-app, WhatsApp, SMS) — hosts may not open the app daily.
- Optional profile photo taken in-app, auto-compressed.
- Progressive profile: start listing before the profile is complete; cannot go live until verified.
- Registration needs signal for OTP; everything after tolerates disconnection.
- Alternative entry (*to validate for MVP*): message a WhatsApp number to start onboarding conversationally, or be onboarded by a Community Champion.

Verify (tiered KYC)

Two goals in tension: enough trust for a traveller to book a stranger, low enough friction that the people the platform exists for are not excluded.

Tier	Requirement	Can do
0 Registered	Phone verified	Draft offerings; not live
1 Identity verified	SA ID, passport or asylum/refugee permit + in-app selfie (liveness, face match)	List and accept bookings up to a value cap
2 Community or credential verified	Tourist guide number, PSIRA number, operating licence + PrDP, a reference from a Tier 2 host, or endorsement from a partner (tourism office, community org, NGO, Community Champion)	Cap removed; "verified" badge; same-day payout

Community endorsement is the path for hosts who have no formal credentials but are known and trusted locally — this is where the Champion model earns its place. The payments partner carries FICA compliance (*to validate*: Yoco, Peach Payments, Ozow, Stitch, PayFast). POPIA: minimum data, clear consent, ID documents encrypted and never shown to travellers. Document capture must work on a bad camera in bad light, with retries.

Create an offering (voice-to-listing)

The single most important flow in the product and the demo's centrepiece.

None

flowchart TD

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A[Host records voice note<br/>in own language] --> B[Speech-to-text]
B --> C[Translate + draft structured listing]
C --> D[Host reviews, corrects,<br/>one field per screen]
D --> E[Add 3 photos<br/>client-side compressed]
E --> F[Price suggested from<br/>category and comparables]
F --> G[Preview in traveller's language]
G --> H[Publish or save offline]
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- AI drafts: title, description, category, duration, group size, suggested price, inclusions, meeting point. Category-specific questions per the Categories section.
- Guided form fallback: one question per screen, plain language, examples, save-as-you-go, resumable offline.
- Photos: take or upload, compressed on device; AI suggests the lead photo and flags unusable ones. Three photos is enough to go live.
- Location: pin, town name, or a shared WhatsApp location. Works without precise GPS.
- Availability: specific dates, recurring days, or "on request with confirmation" (default for hosts with day jobs).
- Offline: drafts save locally with a clear "waiting to upload" state.

Manage offerings and bookings

- Offering statuses: draft, in review, live, paused, rejected (with a plain-language reason). Edit, pause, duplicate, delete. Simple performance view: views, bookings, earnings.
- Moderation: automated checks first, human review for flagged items.
- Booking requests arrive by push, WhatsApp or SMS per host preference. Accept or decline with one tap, including from WhatsApp.
- Booking detail: who, when, how many, what they paid, meeting point, traveller's number (revealed after acceptance).
- Calendar/list of upcoming bookings, usable offline. Host cancellation with reason and consequences explained; repeat cancellations affect ranking.
- Mark as completed, which triggers payout.

Get paid (the financial half of the USP)

The platform collects from the traveller, holds the money, and pays the host after completion (escrow-style). Payout options in priority order (*to validate* fees, limits, API availability):

Channel	Examples	For whom
Bank account (instant EFT)	Any SA bank	Banked hosts
Cardless cash-send to a phone number	FNB eWallet, Standard Bank Instant Money, Absa CashSend, Nedbank Send-iMali	Primary unbanked path; withdraw at ATM or retailer with a PIN
Mobile money / wallet	MTN MoMo, VodaPay, Shoprite Money Market	Airtime, groceries, bills without cash
Cash pickup voucher	Shoprite, Pick n Pay, Boxer, Pep	Hosts far from an ATM
Cash on the day	Platform does not touch it; smaller traveller-paid fee	Bridge only; weaker trust and dispute protection

Requirements: show the host exactly what they will receive in rand *before* they publish, after fees. Payout within 24 hours of completion, same day for Tier 2. Earnings screen shows total earned, pending, paid out, per booking — this is the impact screen for the pitch. Fee model to decide (commission 15–20% is the industry norm; keep the host-side fee low and visible). Tier 1 hosts may be capped per month until Tier 2. Hosts are independent; provide an annual earnings statement; no withholding at MVP.

Worked example for the demo: a R600 township food tour at a 15% platform fee shows the host "You will receive R510" before publishing, and "R510 sent to 082 xxx xxxx via eWallet" after completion.

Demand-Side Flows

Browse

- Entry points: by place ("what is there to do in Montagu"), by category, and by route for travellers moving between places.
- Filters: category, price, date, group size, language spoken, verification tier, distance.

- Listing card: lead photo, title, host first name + verification badge, price, duration, rating, town.
- Listing detail: photos, description translated into the traveller's language, inclusions, meeting point, host profile and story, reviews, availability, cancellation terms, safety notes. The host's story matters: travellers are choosing a person, not a product.
- Natural-language search backed by AI ("somewhere to eat real food near Beaufort West tonight").

Co-create the itinerary (our distinctive demand feature)

None

flowchart LR

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A[Organiser starts a trip<br/>and invites the group] --> B[Anyone drags
listings<br/>onto the day timeline]
B --> C[Group votes<br/>on each block]
C --> D[Conflicts and travel time<br/>flagged automatically]
D --> E[Itinerary locked<br/>when the group agrees]
E --> F[One checkout<br/>for everything]
F --> G[Each host accepts<br/>their booking]

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- A trip is a shared, Facebook-style timeline grouped by day. Every invited traveller can add blocks; the group votes; the organiser locks it.
- Travel time between items is shown and conflicts are warned.
- AI assist: "plan my day in Graaff-Reinet" proposes a set of listings the group can then edit and vote on.
- Share the itinerary as a link (a growth loop: friends see it, hosts share their bookings).
- Book all items in one checkout or one at a time.

Book and pay

- Pick date/time, group size, options. Instant book where the host allows it, otherwise request-to-book with a response deadline (say 4 hours) and automatic release of the hold.
- Guest details: name, phone, WhatsApp opt-in, language. Clear total with fees before payment.
- Payment: Visa/Mastercard, Apple Pay, Google Pay, instant EFT (Ozow or similar), SnapScan/Zapper QR for domestic users; international cards for visitors. ZAR with an approximate conversion for internationals.
- Funds held until completion, then released to the host. Refunds follow the cancellation policy. Receipt by email or WhatsApp.
- Confirmation includes meeting point, host contact (after acceptance) and add-to-calendar.

Manage bookings and stay safe

- Upcoming and past bookings with status: requested, confirmed, completed, cancelled. Cancel with clear terms (free window, partial refund, none). Reschedule request to the host.
- Contact host in-app with WhatsApp fallback.
- Safety: share trip with a contact; emergency button with local emergency numbers and location sharing.

Review

- Prompt after completion, both directions. Star rating + short text, optional photos.
- Moderated for abuse; shown once both sides submit or a window passes. Hosts can respond once.
- Low-rated or reported experiences trigger a support workflow.

Offering Categories

Each category gets its own short listing template so voice-to-listing asks the right questions.

Category	Examples	Category-specific fields	Regulatory note (to validate)
Experiences	Township walk, home-cooked meal, farm visit, craft workshop, storytelling, choir, fishing, hike	Duration, group min/max, inclusions, physical difficulty, age suitability, languages	Food safety for meals; guiding may need registration if it is the core service
Transport	Airport transfer, town-to-town, day drive, lift to trailhead, luggage transfer	Vehicle type and seats, luggage capacity, pickup radius, per-trip vs per-km pricing, child seats	Operating licence, PrDP, roadworthy, passenger liability insurance
Concierge and guides	Full-day local guide, multi-stop day, arranging access to places or people	Areas covered, languages, specialities, per-hour or per-day pricing	Provincial tourist guide registration (Tourism Act)

Category	Examples	Category-specific fields	Regulatory note (to validate)
Security	Foot or vehicle escort, night escort, event presence, vehicle following	PSIRA grade, armed/unarmed, coverage area, hours	PSIRA registration mandatory; never list unregistered providers

Hackathon recommendation: seed and demo Experiences and Concierge/guides only; show Transport and Security as categories in the UI but gated behind Tier 2 credentials, which tells judges we have thought about compliance without building it.

Trust, Safety and Compliance

- Both sides verified: host tiers as above; travellers by phone plus payment method. Badges visible on listings and profiles.
- Safety notes on every listing: meeting point, what to bring, what to expect.
- Share-trip and emergency button for travellers; "report a problem" for both sides.
- Insurance: explore a platform-level public liability policy for hosts (*to validate with a broker*). A real barrier for small operators and a strong pitch point.
- Regulated categories (transport, security, registered guiding) require the credential at Tier 2 before going live.
- POPIA: lawful basis, consent, data minimisation, right to deletion, ID documents encrypted at rest and never shown to other users.
- Content moderation on listings, photos and reviews.
- Terms, cancellation policy and community guidelines in plain language and in the host's language.
- Community Champions add a human trust layer: an endorsement is logged, visible as a badge, and revocable.

Hackathon MVP Scope (24 Hours)

Build the thinnest end-to-end slice that proves both halves of the USP on stage. Everything must be demoable on a phone.

Must demo

1. Host onboarding with phone OTP (mocked OTP is fine) and language selection.
2. Voice-to-listing in at least one language beyond English (isiXhosa or isiZulu preferred, Afrikaans as fallback): record, transcribe, draft, host edits, publish. The centrepiece.
3. Host earnings and payout screen showing a completed payout to a phone number (cash-send), with the "you will receive Rx" shown before publishing.

4. Traveller marketplace: browse by place and category across 3–4 SA regions; listing detail with the host's story and verification badge.
5. Group itinerary: shared day timeline, drag-and-drop (or tap-to-add) blocks, simple vote, lock.
6. Booking with a convincing payment mock (or gateway sandbox) and host accept from the app; a WhatsApp accept shown as a mock message.
7. Seed data: 10–20 realistic listings from realistic personas in real places (e.g. Observatory bike tour, Stellenbosch tram tour, a Langa home-cooked meal, a Soweto walk, a Hogsback hike, a Karoo farm visit).

Phase 2 (in the PRD, not the build)

Tiered KYC with a real provider, real cash-send payouts, WhatsApp onboarding channel, offline sync, AI itinerary planning, reviews, category templates for transport and security with credential checks, community endorsement flow, insurance partnership, Facebook forum aggregation.

Explicitly out of scope

Accommodation, flights, native app-store apps, USSD, multi-currency settlement, rich in-app chat, loyalty, real payments or bank linking.

Fallbacks if time runs short (decide at hour 12): drop drag-and-drop for tap-to-add; drop voting for organiser-only lock; drop live speech-to-text for a pre-recorded voice note with cached transcription; keep the payout screen no matter what.

The Demo Script

Judges score Idea, Execution, Design, Pitch and Impact. The pitch should be one story told through two people, not a feature tour. Aim for 4 minutes of demo inside a 6–7 minute slot.

Minute	Beat	On screen	Judging box it ticks
0:00	The hook: "Tourism is one of SA's biggest employers. Here is who it leaves out." One sourced stat.	Title slide, one number	Pitch, Impact
0:30	Meet the host: Nomsa in Langa cooks for visitors, gets paid in cash	Photo of a persona, one line	Idea

Minute	Beat	On screen	Judging box it ticks
	when a friend sends someone. No website, no bank account.		
1:00	Nomsa taps the WhatsApp-style app, picks isiXhosa, records a 20-second voice note about her meal.	Live on phone: voice recording	Design, Execution
1:30	The listing drafts itself in English and isiXhosa: title, price suggestion, photos. She fixes one word and sees "You will receive R510" before publishing.	Live: AI draft, edit, publish	Execution, Design, Impact
2:15	Meet the travellers: four friends on a Cape Town weekend. One finds Nomsa's meal and drags it onto Saturday. The others vote. The itinerary locks.	Live: shared timeline, votes	Idea, Design
3:00	One checkout. Nomsa gets a WhatsApp: accept with one tap.	Live: payment mock, host accept	Execution
3:30	Saturday happens. Nomsa marks it complete. "R510 sent to 082 xxx xxxx via eWallet." Her	Live: payout + earnings	Impact

Minute	Beat	On screen	Judging box it ticks
	earnings screen shows the month.		
4:00	Zoom out: this is how the same flow works for a taxi driver in Soweto, a hiking guide in Hogsback, a farm in the Karoo.	Map with seeded listings across regions	Impact, Idea
4:30	The ask and the roadmap: tiered KYC, real cash-send, champions in every community. One slide.	Roadmap	Pitch
5:00	Close on the line: "We built for the host's journey, so the traveller's journey has someone real at the end of it."	Title slide	Pitch

Rules for the demo: pre-record the voice note as a fallback and cache the transcription; never rely on venue Wi-Fi for speech-to-text; rehearse the handoff between the two phones; assign one presenter to narrate and one to drive; keep the payout screen on stage for at least five seconds — it is the money shot.

Judging Criteria Alignment

Criterion	Our answer	Proof point in the demo
Idea	Flip the camera: the host is the hero. Voice-first, bank-account-optional supply side; group co-creation on the demand side	Nomsa's voice note becomes a listing; friends vote on it
Execution	A working PWA covering onboarding, voice-to-listing,	Two phones, one continuous flow, no slides mid-demo

Criterion	Our answer	Proof point in the demo
	marketplace, group itinerary, booking, host accept and payout — end to end	
Design	WhatsApp-familiar UI for hosts (one question per screen, big targets, own language); visual timeline for travellers; low-data by principle	Language picker first; "You will receive R510" before publish
Pitch	One story, two people, one sourced number, a clear roadmap	The demo script above
Impact	Rand into unbanked hands; hosts who never typed a listing; regions with no listings on incumbents	Payout to a phone number; map of seeded listings across regions; impact metrics slide

Checkpoint Submission

Prototype link: [add once deployed]

250-word write-up (draft, 248 words):

Tourism is one of South Africa's largest job-creating sectors, yet the people with the most authentic offering — the local guide, the taxi driver, the home cook, the person who knows who to call — are structurally locked out of the platforms where travellers spend money. Listing on those platforms assumes a good phone, cheap data, written English and a bank account to be paid into. Many hosts have an entry-level Android, a rationed prepaid bundle, more comfort speaking than typing, and no bank account. If you cannot list and cannot be paid, you cannot participate.

We built a two-sided marketplace that removes those barriers on the supply side. A host chooses their language, records a voice note describing what they offer, and AI drafts a structured, translated listing they correct and publish in minutes. Verification is tiered so a phone number and ID are enough to start, with community endorsement as a path to full trust. Payouts go to a bank account, a cash-send phone number, a mobile wallet or a retail pickup — the host sees exactly what they will receive in rand before publishing.

On the demand side, groups of friends or family co-create a journey: they drag experiences onto a shared timeline, vote, lock the plan and pay once. Each host accepts with one tap, including from WhatsApp.

Our prototype demonstrates the full loop across several South African regions: voice to listing, listing to group itinerary, booking to a payout the host can actually collect. We built for the host's journey, so the traveller's journey has someone real at the end of it.

Tech Stack, Architecture and Non-Functional Requirements

Team default, to be confirmed by the devs:

Layer	Choice	Notes
App	Next.js PWA on Vercel	One codebase, two shells: host (WhatsApp-like, text-first) and traveller (visual timeline)
Backend	Supabase: auth, Postgres, storage, row-level security, edge functions	Edge functions for sync and webhooks
AI	Speech-to-text for SA languages; LLM for listing drafting, translation, natural-language search	Evaluate isiXhosa/isiZulu accuracy on day one; fall back to English + review step if poor. For the demo, cache transcriptions
Payments	One SA gateway for card + instant EFT (<i>to validate</i> : Peach, Yoco, Ozow, Stitch) plus a payout provider	Mocked at hackathon; sandbox if one is quick
Messaging	WhatsApp Business API via Twilio, Clickatell or 360dialog; SMS via Clickatell	Mocked as on-screen WhatsApp messages at hackathon; Yazi for community surveys
Maps	Google Maps or Mapbox on the demand side; static or none on the supply side	Saves data for hosts

Layer	Choice	Notes
Analytics	Impact metrics instrumented from day one	Even in the demo, log the events

Non-functional requirements

- Low-end performance: supply-side first load under 500 KB, right-sized images, no heavy client frameworks on critical paths.
- Offline: supply-side drafts, offerings and bookings available offline; sync with conflict handling; clear unsynced state. (Phase 2 for the build; design for it now.)
- Data cost: tell hosts roughly how much data an action uses where material (photo upload).
- Languages: UI in EN, AF, XH, ZU at MVP with a path to all 11; listings translated automatically both ways.
- Channels: PWA primary; WhatsApp for notifications and simple actions; SMS fallback; USSD later.
- Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA, large touch targets, high contrast, screen-reader labels, readable in bright sunlight.
- Resilience: host actions queue during load shedding or signal loss; travellers are told the host may respond late.
- Security: OTP auth, encrypted PII, payments handled entirely by the partner.
- Brand: apply the Specno UI guidelines (Specno Blue, Nunito/Inter, minimalist components) so the prototype looks finished, not hacked.

Success and Impact Metrics

The pitch should promise to measure these, and the prototype should show a mock impact dashboard built from them.

Impact metrics

Metric	Why it matters	Target
Hosts onboarded who are unbanked, first-time platform sellers, or from areas with no incumbent listings	The exclusion we exist to remove	Majority of hosts
Rand paid out to hosts, and share via non-bank channels	Money reaching people, not intermediaries	Track from day one

Metric	Why it matters	Target
Time from registration to first live listing	Proves the onboarding USP	Under 15 minutes with voice-to-listing
Hosts onboarded voice-only, and without a bank account	Proves both halves of the USP	Report both
Average host earnings per month; hosts for whom it is a meaningful supplement	Livelihood impact	Define "meaningful" with hosts
Bookings completed; repeat bookings	The marketplace works	Track

Product metrics

- Supply: registration completion, verification completion by tier, publish rate, acceptance rate, response time.
- Demand: search-to-booking conversion, itinerary share rate, cancellation rate, review rate, rating distribution.
- Trust: disputes per 100 bookings, safety reports, fraud rate.

24-Hour Build Plan

Work in two parallel streams (host app, traveller app) that meet at hour 16. Assign owners in the right-hand column.

Hours	Host stream	Traveller stream	Shared / owner
0–2	Confirm stack, scaffold PWA, pick STT/LLM provider and test isiXhosa/isiZulu once	Wireframe timeline and listing card	Seed data: 10–20 listings across 3–4 regions; personas; photos. Design tokens from Specno guidelines
2–6	OTP mock, language picker, WhatsApp-style shell	Browse by place/category, listing detail with host story	Supabase schema: hosts, listings, trips, blocks, votes, bookings, payouts

Hours	Host stream	Traveller stream	Shared / owner
6–10	Voice record → transcribe → LLM draft → review screens	Shared trip timeline, add blocks (tap first, drag if time)	AI prompt for listing drafting and translation
10–14	Publish flow with "you will receive Rx"; offerings list	Voting, lock, checkout mock	Hour 12 checkpoint: apply fallbacks if behind
14–16	Booking inbox, one-tap accept, mock WhatsApp accept	Booking confirmation, itinerary share link	Connect the streams end to end
16–19	Mark complete → payout to phone number → earnings screen	Polish timeline, map of seeded listings	Impact dashboard mock
19–21	Bug fixes, brand polish, mobile QA on a real low-end Android	Bug fixes, brand polish	Deploy to Vercel; prototype link
21–23	Record fallback voice note and cache transcription	Rehearse traveller phone	Write checkpoint submission; build 5-slide deck; rehearse demo twice
23–24	Buffer	Buffer	Final rehearsal; charge phones; submit

Decisions Needed and Open Questions

Decide before the build starts (hour 0):

- ☐ Working name and one-line tagline. Candidates to react to: *Khaya Trails* (khaya = home), *Ubuntu Journeys*, *Local Ledger*, *Hlala* (stay/sit). Pick something a host can say and a judge can spell.
- ☐ Demo language for voice-to-listing: isiXhosa, isiZulu or Afrikaans, based on the hour-0 STT test.

- ☐ Demo persona and region set (recommended: Langa meal, Observatory bike tour, Stellenbosch tram, Soweto walk, Hogsback hike, Karoo farm).
- ☐ Drag-and-drop vs tap-to-add for the itinerary, and whether voting ships or organiser-lock only.
- ☐ Fee shown in the demo (recommend 15% so the host-receives number is clean).

Open questions for the PO (phase 2):

- Fee model: commission only, traveller fee only, or split? What rate keeps hosts whole?
- Which payout channel first: cash-send or a retailer wallet? Which has a usable API?
- Require registered tourist-guide status for all guiding, or only where the host positions as a guide?
- List security at MVP given PSIRA, or hold the category?
- Instant book vs request-to-book as default for hosts with day jobs.
- Who moderates listings at launch, and what is the SLA?
- Insurance: platform policy or host's own?
- Speech-to-text quality in isiXhosa and isiZulu: provider and fallback.
- Hosts who share a phone: one device, several hosts?
- How community endorsers (tourism offices, NGOs, Champions) get onboarded and what they see.
- Brand and tone of voice.

Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Two-sided cold start	Seed one area deeply with real hosts rather than the country thinly; partner with local tourism offices, community organisations and Champions for supply
Payout compliance (FICA, limits) re-introduces exclusion	Tiered model; a partner that supports low-KYC wallets
Safety incident on either side	Verification, share-trip, insurance, responsive support
AI transcription quality in SA languages	Human review and English fallback; for the demo, pre-recorded note with cached transcription
Regulated categories (transport, security) carry legal exposure	Credentials required before go-live; start with experiences and guiding

Risk	Mitigation
Extractive-platform perception	Low, visible host fee; earnings transparency on every screen
Hackathon: venue Wi-Fi fails during live STT	Cached transcription; offline-capable demo build; hotspot on a second phone
Hackathon: two streams do not integrate in time	Shared schema at hour 2; integration checkpoint at hour 14–16; fallbacks decided at hour 12
Hackathon: demo looks like a feature tour	Follow the demo script; one story, two people, one payout screen